

Preparing for a Productive Collaboration with your Client and with your Partner

Project Management, Monitoring, and Evaluation

Definition

“Project progress tracking is the continuous process of monitoring and measuring how well a project is advancing relative to its original scope, timeline, and budget. It involves regularly reviewing tasks, milestones, resource usage, and deliverables to ensure that each element of the project is progressing as expected... Project tracking turns planning into performance. It's more than a checkbox; it's a discipline that connects day-to-day activity with strategic objectives. organizations can not only reduce risk but also improve accountability and transparency across all levels of a project. Effective monitoring can help you get the most up-to-date and accurate information. The state and development of the project can be easily visible to everyone involved.”

Source: <https://www.timetackle.com/project-progress-tracking/>

High Level Summaries

- Project tracking is the process of managing a project's resources, including time, budgets, and people, to ensure deliverables are finalized without **cost overrun** or significant delays.
- The main challenges include risk identification and management, transparent stakeholder communication, getting relevant **project management metrics**, and adapting to changes.
- Some progress-tracking strategies are: setting up regular feedback loops, establishing clear goals and responsibilities, and setting up a system to manage KPIs and **resource capacity**.
- Modern **project management software for professional services** can help keep your project plan within project costs and timelines and project progress reports.

Source: <https://productive.io/blog/project-progress/>

1 Identify Issues

2 Set Milestones

3 Improve Communication

Be the first to add your personal experience

4 Utilize Tools

5 Adjust Strategies

6 Feedback Loops

Be the first to add your personal experience

7 Here's what else to consider

Source: <https://www.linkedin.com/advice/0/what-do-you-your-consulting-project-progress-difficult-zsxbf>

What are some specific things to do?

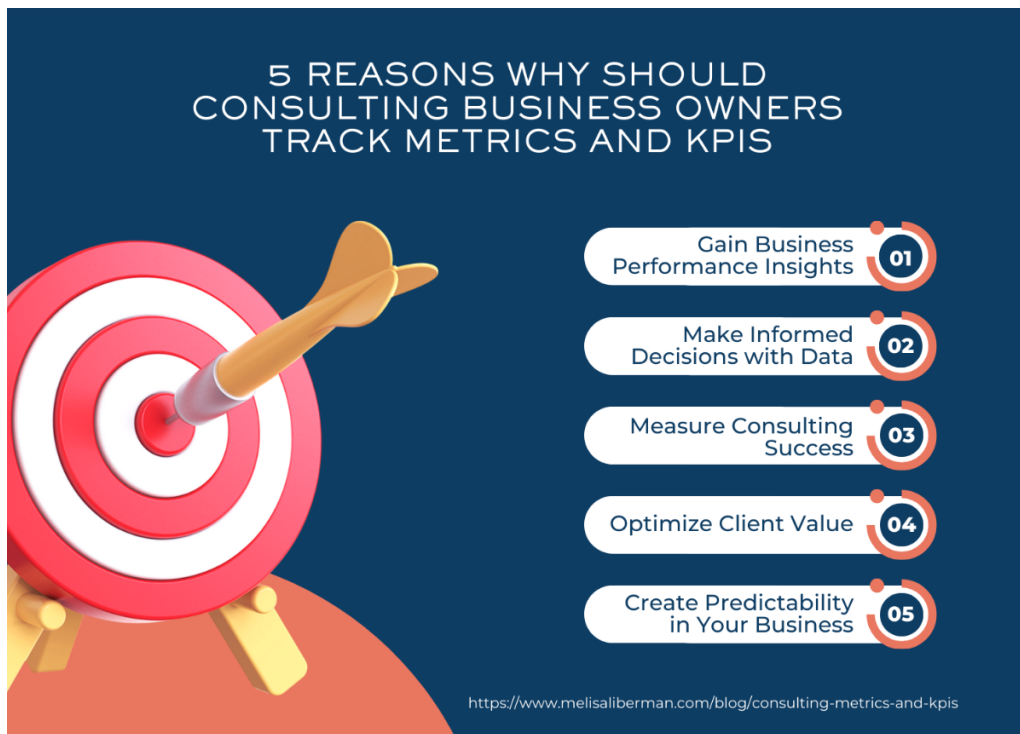
8. Track everything related to the project

People aren't the only resource you need to manage. To keep the project on track, you also need to:

- Track KPIs
- Manage variances and take corrective action
- Focus on quality assurance
- Manage risk
- Check scope creep

Source: <https://www.teamwork.com/blog/project-management-best-practices/>

Key Performance Indicators



9 TYPES OF METRICS & KPIS TO TRACK FOR YOUR CONSULTING BUSINESS

1. Financial Metrics

2. Business Development, Marketing,
and Lead Generation Metrics

3. Resource Utilization Metrics

4. Metrics and KPIs Related to
Operational Effectiveness

5. Client Relationship Metrics

6. Client Delivery Quality Metrics

7. Key (Internal) Business
Initiative Metrics

8. Personal Productivity Metrics

9. Mindset Metrics

<https://www.melisaliberman.com/blog/consulting-metrics-and-kpis>

Source: <https://www.melisaliberman.com/blog/consulting-metrics-and-kpis>

What are specific things to anticipate or monitor?

“In project management, RAID stands for risks, assumptions, issues, and dependencies. These four components provide a framework for identifying and managing potential challenges and dependencies in a project. Completing a RAID analysis helps ensure proactive responses and effective communication throughout the project lifecycle. Project managers use this framework to highlight potential challenges and dependencies, allowing for proactive decision-making.”



RAID Component	Definition	Example
Risk (R)	These are uncertain events or conditions that, if they occur, can have an effect on the project outcome.	Resistance from employees might impact the adoption rate of the new HR software.
Assumption (A)	These are conditions believed to be true or things assumed to be in place, upon which the project plan is based.	All employees have the basic computer skills necessary to navigate and use the new HR software.
Issue (I)	These are current challenges or problems that are negatively affecting the project or have the potential to do so if not addressed.	There are technical glitches in the newly implemented HR system that need to be resolved
Dependency (D)	These are tasks, milestones, or components that are reliant on one another for their progression or completion.	The training schedule for the new HR software is dependent on the successful installation and setup of the software.

Source: https://www.smartsheet.com/content/raid-project-management?srltid=AfmBOoqs1SHajdS_LIVgoebCQjR8z6MbfbyojB32nMvqQXY8oTfGnYcv

What do feedback loops look like?

[Feedback loops are the backbone of efficient software deployments](#). They allow teams to identify and address issues at every stage, reducing delays and ensuring reliable updates. Here's what you need to know:

- **Automated Testing:** Quickly catches errors after every code commit, reducing defects by up to 90%.
- **Real-Time Monitoring:** Detects problems instantly, improving recovery times by 40%.
- **Peer Code Reviews:** Adds a human layer to quality checks, spotting logic and design flaws.
- **User Feedback:** Ensures updates align with user needs, improving satisfaction and prioritisation.
- **Continuous Metrics Evaluation:** Tracks deployment frequency, failure rates, and recovery times to refine processes.

Feedback Source	Collection Method	Strengths	Limitations
End Users	Surveys, in-app tools	Direct insight into usability	May require incentives
Stakeholders	Interviews, meetings	Aligns with business goals	Can be time-intensive
Automated Analytics	Usage data, error logs	Scalable and objective	Lacks qualitative context
Retrospectives	Team meetings	Improves internal processes	Limited to internal perspectives

Source: <https://hokstadconsulting.com/blog/5-feedback-loop-practices-for-faster-deployments>

Top Down Accountability Example



Source: <https://www.rhythmsystems.com/blog/accountability-problems>

9. Keep project documents up to date

- RACI matrix (listing who's **R**esponsible, **A**ccountable, **C**onsulted, **I**nformed for each task)
- Risks and issues log
- Change requests
- Project schedule
- Project expenses
- Retrospective log

Source: <https://www.teamwork.com/blog/project-management-best-practices/>

Collaboration and Teamwork

A project collaboration plan helps teams



Improve communication
and transparency



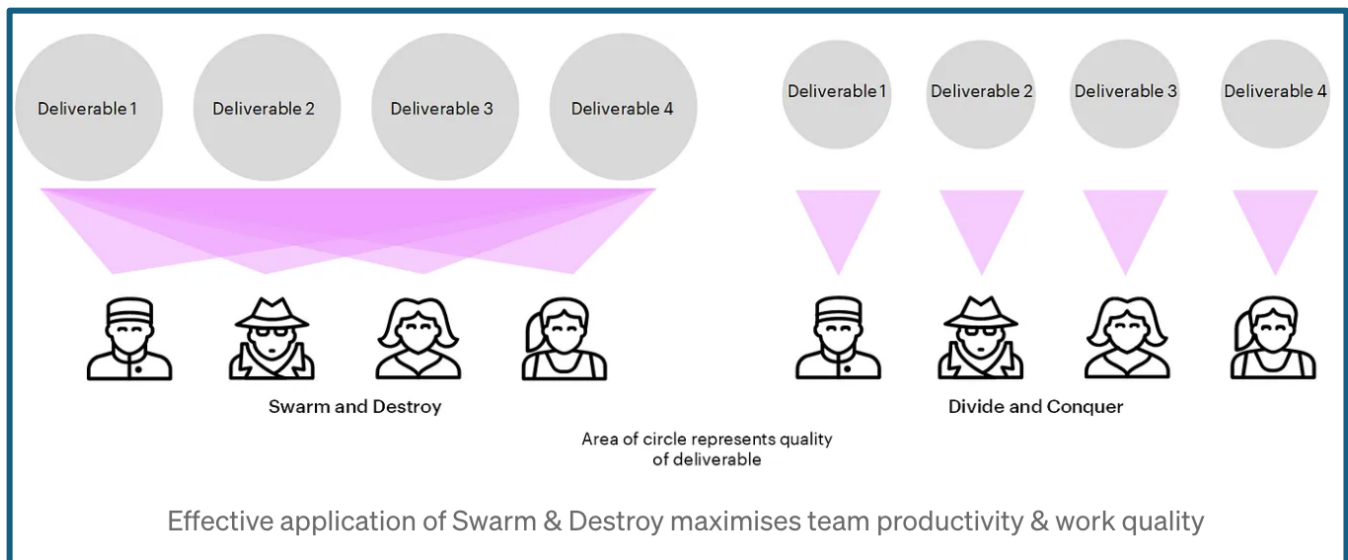
Increase efficiency
and engagement



Share resources and
information easily

Source: <https://blog.box.com/collaborative-project-planning-best-practices>

One Example ... SWARM



Source: <https://medium.com/@WillBrouwer/the-management-consultants-guide-to-working-in-a-team-cfe2aa3cb208>

Does Teamwork Really Matter?

“These team health drivers, when viewed collectively, explain between **69 and 76 percent of the differences** between low- and high-performing teams when it comes to three key outcomes: **efficiency** (the team is productive and meets its deadlines); **results** (the team delivers on objectives and delights stakeholders, customers, and/or clients); and **innovation** (the team innovates in a way that is critical to long-term organizational value).”

Team effectiveness is based on multiple health drivers in four areas that define how well teams work together.

Four areas	Health driver	The degree to which team members ...
Configuration <i>Do we have role clarity and the necessary mix of internal and external perspectives?</i>	Diverse perspectives	Have a mix of perspectives that move the team's work forward
	External orientation	Are connected to networks outside the core team and/or broader organization to learn new perspectives
	Role definition	Understand the expectations and responsibilities of individual roles and have the right people in them
Alignment <i>Are we committed to the team and are we clear on our purpose and goals?</i>	Commitment	Are committed to the team and prioritize its success over their own
	Goals	Have individual- and/or team-level goals that are challenging to achieve and are aligned to the priorities of the organization
	Purpose	Are aligned on a clear team purpose and can articulate what the team is meant to accomplish

Execution <i>Are we effectively carrying out our day-to-day work?</i>	Collaboration	Have agreed-upon norms that accelerate collaboration and improve ways of working
	Communication	Communicate sufficiently and effectively, and choose the right communication methods
	Decision making	Define clear roles in the decision-making process, make quick, high-quality decisions, and learn from poor decisions
	Feedback	Give honest and effective feedback, invite direct feedback, and receive coaching support
	Meeting effectiveness	Focus on actionable items, involve the right people at the right time, and follow through on next steps

Renewal <i>Do we create the right working environment and enact practices for long-term learning and improvement?</i>	Belonging	Feel they are a part of the team and can be themselves
	Conflict management	Address conflicts effectively and in ways that improve team relationships
	Innovative thinking	Seek out opposing perspectives, have open discussions about change, and encourage out-of-the-box thinking and solutions
	Psychological safety	Feel comfortable making mistakes and taking risks without fear of negative consequences, constructively disagree with one another, and proactively invite each other's input
	Recognition	Are recognized for excellent performance, celebrate one another's accomplishments, and hold one another to consistent performance standards
	Trust	Feel they can rely on one another, give each other the space to get work done, and demonstrate good judgment

Source: <https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/people-and-organizational-performance/our-insights/go-teams-when-teams-get-healthier-the-whole-organization-benefits>

Specific Collaboration Ideas

There are several tools and strategies that teams can use to improve their functioning and productivity. Some examples include using the following documents:

- **Team Charter**. Identifies rules and expectations agreed upon by the team, as well as individual member roles.
- **Meeting-Related Documents**.
 - **Meeting Agenda**. Outlines main points for discussion at a meeting.
 - **Meeting Minutes**. Record decisions and relevant discussion points for a meeting.
- **Work Log**. Records the tasks and time spent for each team member.
- **Status Report or Status Update**. Records the completed tasks and work left to complete (see [Chapter 19](#)).
- **Gantt Chart or Task Schedule**. Breaks down tasks and their estimated duration over the work period.

Source: <https://odp.library.tamu.edu/howdyorhello/chapter/documents-and-tools-to-improve-team-effectiveness/>

Don't Forget Your Professional Growth

How to Be a Good Project Manager: 10 Tips to Follow

6. Encourage continuous learning

Promote a culture of continuous learning and professional development within your team. Encourage team members to enhance their skills, stay updated with industry trends, and share knowledge with one another.

7. Foster a positive team culture

Create a supportive and inclusive team culture that encourages collaboration, innovation, and open communication. Recognize and celebrate individual and team achievements to boost morale.

Source: <https://www.bigtime.net/blogs/steps-to-improve-project-management-effectiveness/>

Homework:

Prep for a conversation with a partner and your client

- (1) Logging Time and Scheduling Plan
- (2) Documentation Plan
- (3) Accountability Plan
- (4) Communication Plan
- (5) Shared Work Space Preferences
- (6) Feedback Loops you will need
- (7) Professional Growth Goals

Prompts:

What do you think you absolutely need?

What is desirable?

What has or has not worked for you in the past?

What good or bad work/communication habits do you have?

What do you want to try?

When are you available or not available?

When are you most or least productive?